



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

The client is always right ... or not!



Learning Outcome

Accurately use important information about people's jobs and places of work in communicative situations.

Ask your partner:

- Do you know someone who works in a restaurant?
- How do they deal with difficult customers?
- How would you deal with a difficult customer?

Can Do Statements

- I can deal with non-standard requests and refuse politely.
- I can respond politely to suggestions and offers.
- I can express what is necessary.





Let's Explore!

Vanessa tries to deal with the rude customer. The situation **escalates*** quickly!

* A situation "escalates" when it gets worse.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Vanessa:** Good afternoon, sir. What seems to be the problem here?
Steve: I was on the phone with a client when your employee asked me to end the conversation! This is a deal breaker!
Vanessa: I am sorry to hear that, but she was only doing her job.
Steve: She was extremely rude!
Vanessa: Sir, we take great care in hiring our waiters and floor staff. Sarah was very patient and polite.
Steve: This is unacceptable! I am one of your most valued customers! I can take my calls whenever I want to!
Vanessa: Sir, you might want to lower your voice. You are yelling in front of everyone.
Steve: So what? Do you know who I am?
Vanessa: I am sure you're a very busy person, but you ought to calm down. You should continue enjoying your meal. May I offer you a complimentary dessert?
Steve: You'd better know who you're talking to! I can shut this place down if I want to.
Vanessa: Sir, I'm going to have to ask you to leave.





Let's Practice!

"Service with a smile!" Vanessa should remember these magic words!

Instructions: Read the sentences carefully. There are two possible options. Circle the correct word in each sentence. Using the sentences, model a conversation with your partner. Switch roles.

1. I understand, sir, but we **take / taking** great care in hiring our waiters and floor staff.
2. Good afternoon, sir. What **seems / seem** to be the problem here?
3. May I offer you a complimentary **dessert / desert** ?
4. What seems to **being / be** the problem?
5. I am sorry to **hear / here** that, but she was only doing her job.
6. You should continue **enjoying / enjoy** your meal.



Let's Practice!

Customers should remain polite.

Instructions: Write down the words from the box to correctly complete the sentences. Using the sentences, model a conversation with your partner. Switch roles.

Word Bank

better / 've got / to have to / might

1. I _____ to take this call. It's extremely important!
2. You _____ want to lower your voice.
3. You'd _____ know who you're talking to!
4. I'm going _____ ask you to leave.





Extension Activity

Let's write a dialogue about ordering food.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Role-play a situation at a restaurant. Choose between the following roles:
- Write a dialogue (12-14 lines) about the situation.
- Read the dialogue aloud.
- Change roles with your partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes **No**

I write a dialogue about dealing with difficult customers.

☐ ☐

I offer suggestions and respond politely.

☐ ☐

I express what is necessary and refuse politely.

☐ ☐

I role-play the dialogue in front of others.

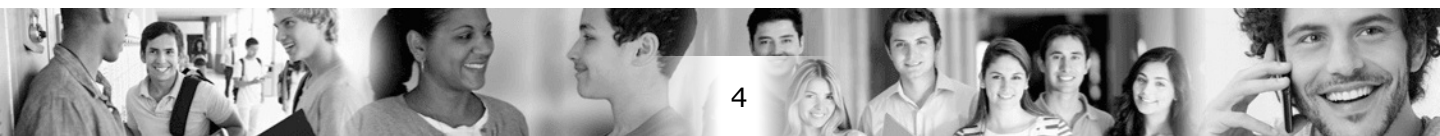
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Student A Role	Student B Role
You are a waiter or waitress. You make suggestions about the menu and reply politely to requests.	You are a difficult customer. You have questions and requests for the waiter or waitress. You eventually decide what to order.



Target Words

- deal breaker** (expression): a serious issue; a problem
e.g. What do you mean I can't use my phone? This is a deal breaker!
- So what?** (expression): I don't care!
e.g.
Ann: You are yelling in front of everyone.
Bob: So what?
- floor staff** (noun): employees who work in a restaurant, setting and cleaning tables
e.g. We train our floor staff to deal with difficult customers.
- unacceptable** (adjective): impossible to accept
e.g. What do you mean I can't use my phone? This is unacceptable.
- valued** (adjective): held in high regard; important
e.g. I am one of your most valued customers!
- extremely** (adverb):: to a great degree
e.g. The customer was extremely rude.
- complimentary** (adjective): at no additional cost
e.g. Please enjoy a complimentary dessert.
- to shut down** (verb): to cease business or operation
e.g. I can shut down your restaurant if I want to!





Learning Points

Dealing With Customers

When you work in a restaurant or in a shop, it is important to deal with customers properly and show politeness.

Remember to respond to their requests politely even when you are refusing the requests. Use the modals *could*, *should* or *might*

Here is a list of ways to start requests and polite responses:

Requesting politely	Refusing requests	Granting requests
• You might want to ... • Would you mind ... ? • You should ... • You ought to ... (strong request)	• I understand, sir/madam, but ... • I'm afraid not • I'm sorry, but ...	• Of course! • Right away. • I'd be happy to do that for you.

Examples:

- **Customer:** *Your waiter was rude! He asked me to turn my phone off!*
- **Manager:** *I'm sorry, but the waiter was doing his job.*
- **Customer:** *You should know who you're talking to!*

Expressing What is Necessary

You use *had better* (*'d better*) to give strong advice, or to tell people what to do. There can be an element of threat: "if you don't do this, something bad will happen."
Example: You'd better know who you're talking to!

Should and *ought to* express mild obligation or advice. *Should* is much more common.
Examples: I am sure you're a very busy person, but you ought to calm down.
You should continue enjoying your meal.

